



Fresh start: Matheesha Pathirana's struggles in 2025 hit MS Dhoni's side hard, but a move to KKR offers him a chance at renewal and relevance. **Right:** Sunrisers Hyderabad will be all-rounder Liam Livingstone's fourth IPL team.

Livingstone eventually found a home at Sunrisers Hyderabad for Rs. 13 crore.

Indian batters Prithvi Shaw and Sarfaraz Khan also needed re-runs before finding teams, both eventually being picked up at their base price of Rs. 75 lakh.

Their modest valuations underscored the league's unforgiving nature and its growing preference

for future-facing investments over stalled potential.

Losing value

Franchises were notably wary of capped Indian players not in the national reckoning. Six of the nine capped Indians who received bids were sold at base price, including Test regular Akash Deep.

Venkatesh Iyer and Ravi Bishnoi

also saw sharp valuation drops after falling out of favour with the Indian team. Venkatesh's price plummeted from Rs. 23.75 crore at the mega auction, while Bishnoi, retained for Rs. 11 crore by Lucknow Super Giants, fetched Rs. 7.2 crore.

State T20 League pipeline

In contrast, 32 uncapped Indian players secured contracts, with

Rs. 2.2 crore

Mumbai Indians spent the lowest auction outlay in IPL history

30 per cent

Kolkata Knight Riders accounted for a major share of the total spend with Rs. 63.85 crore